# Hebrew Alphabet, Perek Shirah and Pirkei Avot

*an appendix to the Kabbalah of Time*

| | THE LETTER | CYCLE | PEREK SHIRAH | PIRKEI AVOT | WEEKS OF THE YEAR |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | א Alef | *1st Cycle* | Heaven | 1. The world was created with ten utterances… | *Three weeks from Selichot to Sukkot* |
| 2 | ב Beit | | Earth | 2. There were ten generations from Adam to Noah…. There were ten generations from Noah to Abraham… | |
| 3 | ג Gimmel | *2nd Cycle* | Garden of Eden | 3. With ten tests our father Abraham was tested and he withstood them all… | *Three weeks from Sukkot to Cheshvan* |
| 4 | ד Dalet | | Gehinnom | 4. Ten miracles were performed for our forefathers in Egypt, and another ten at the sea. Ten afflictions were wrought by G-d upon the Egyptians in Egypt, and another ten at the sea. With ten tests our forefathers tested G-d in the desert… | |
| 5 | ה Heh | *3rd Cycle* | Wilderness | 5. Ten miracles were performed for our forefathers in the Holy Temple… | *Three weeks from Cheshvan to Rosh Chodesh Kislev* |
| 6 | ו Vav | | Fields | 6. Ten things were created at twilight of Shabbat eve… | |
| 7 | ז Zayin | *4th Cycle* | Waters | 7. There are seven things that characterize a boor, and seven that characterize a wise man. | *Three weeks from Rosh Chodesh Kislev to Chanukah* |
| 8 | ח Chet | | Seas | 8. Seven types of retribution come to the world, for seven types of sin. | |
| 9 | ט Tet | *5th Cycle* | Rivers | 9. Carnage by wild beasts comes to the world for false oaths and the desecration of G d's name. Exile comes to the world for idol-worship, sexual promiscuity, murder and the failure to leave the land fallow on the sabbatical year. | *Three weeks from Chanukah to Mid-Tevet* |
| 10 | י Yud | | Wellsprings (last water) | 10. There are four types of people: One who says, "What is mine is yours, and what is yours is mine" is a boor… | |
| 11 | כ Kaf | *6th Cycle* | Day | 11. There are four types of temperaments. One who is easily angered and easily appeased… | *Three weeks from Mid-Tevet to Yud Shvat* |
| 12 | ל Lamed | | Night | 12. There are four types of students… | |

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| 13 | מ Mem | *7th Cycle* | Sun | 13. There are four types of contributors to charity... | *Three weeks from Yud Shvat to Rosh Chodesh Adar* |
| 14 | נ Nun | | Moon | 14. There are four types among those who attend the study hall. | |
| 15/16 | ע ס Samech/Ayin | *8th Cycle* | Stars (last of sky) | 15. There are four types among those who sit before the sages...16. Any love that is dependent on something--when the thing ceases, the love also ceases. But a love that is not dependent on anything never ceases | *Three weeks from Rosh Chodesh Adar to 24th of Adar* |
| 17 | פ Peh | | Thick Clouds | 17. Any dispute that is for the sake of Heaven is destined to endure; one that is not for the sake of Heaven is not destined to endure. | *Three weeks from 25th of Adar to Pessach* |
| 18 | צ Tzadi | *9th Cycle* | Light Clouds | 18. One who causes the community to be meritorious, no sin will come by his hand. One who causes the community to sin, is not given the opportunity to repent. | |
| 19 | ק Kuf | | Wind | 19. Whoever possesses the following three traits is of the disciples of our father Abraham; and whoever possesses the opposite three traits is of the disciples of the wicked Balaam. The disciples of our father Abraham have a good eye, a meek spirit and a humble soul. | *Three weeks from Pessach to 9th of Iyar* |
| 20 | ר Resh | *10th Cycle* | Lighting Bolts | 20. Judah the son of Teima would say: Be bold as a leopard, light as an eagle, fleeting as a deer and mighty as a lion to do the will of your Father in Heaven. He would also say: The brazen--to purgatory; the bashful--to paradise. | |
| 21 | ש Shin | | Dew | 21. Ben Bag Bag would say: Delve and delve into it, for all is in it; see with it; grow old and worn in it; do not budge from it, for there is nothing better.Ben Hei Hei would say: According to the pain is the gain. | *Three weeks from 10th of Iyar to 2nd of Sivan* |
| 22 | ת Tav | *11th Cycle* | Rain (last of clouds) | 22. He would also say: Five years is the age for the study of Scripture. Ten, for the study of Mishnah. Thirteen, for the obligation to observe the mitzvot. | |
| 23 | ך Kaf Sofit | | Wild Trees | 1. The sages expounded in the language of the Mishnah (blessed is He who chose them and their learning):Rabbi Meir would say: Whoever studies Torah for Torah's sake alone, merits many things... | *Three weeks from 3rd of Sivan to 24th of Sivan* |

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| 24 | ך Kaf Sofit | *12th Cycle* | Vine | 2. Said Rabbi Joshua the son of Levi: Every day, an echo resounds from Mount Horeb (Sinai) proclaiming and saying: "Woe is to the creatures who insult the Torah"... | |
| 25 | ם Mem Sofit | | Fig | 3. One who learns from his fellow a single chapter, or a single law, or a single verse, or a single word, or even a single letter, he must treat him with respect... | *Three weeks from 25th of Sivan to 16th of Tammuz* |
| 26 | ם Mem Sofit | *13th Cycle* | Pomegranite | 4. Such is the way of Torah: Bread with salt you shall eat, water in small measure you shall drink, and upon the ground you shall sleep; live a life of deprivation and toil in Torah.... | |
| 27 | ן Nun Sofit | | Palm (Date) | 5. Do not seek greatness for yourself, and do not lust for honor. More than you study, do. Desire not the table of kings, for your table is greater than theirs, and your crown is greater than theirs, and faithful is your Employer to pay you the rewards of your work. | *Three weeks from 17th of Tammuz to Tisha B'Av* |
| 28 | ן Nun Sofit | *14th Cycle* | Esrog (Tapuach) (last tree) | 6. Torah is greater than the priesthood or sovereignty, for sovereignty is acquired with thirty virtues, the priesthood with twenty-four, and Torah is acquired with forty-eight qualities... | |
| 29 | ף Peh Sofit | | Sheaves of Wheat | 7. Great is Torah, for it gives life to its observers in this world, and in the World To Come... | *Three weeks from 10th of Av to Rosh Chodesh Elul* |
| 30 | ף Peh Sofit | *15th Cycle* | Sheaves of Barley | 8. Rabbi Shimon the son of Judah would say in the name of Rabbi Shimon the son of Yochai: Beauty, strength, wealth, honor, wisdom, sageness, old age and children are becoming to the righteous and becoming to the world... | |
| 31 | ץ Tzadi Sofit | | Other Sheaves | 9. Said Rabbi Yossei the son of Kisma: Once, I was traveling and I encountered a man... | *Three weeks from 2nd of Elul to 23rd of Elul,* |
| 32 | ץ Tzadi Sofit | *16th Cycle* | Vegetables of the Field | 10. G-d acquired five acquisitions in his world... | |
| 33. | Vowels | | Grasses | 11. Everything that G-d created in His world, He did not create but for His glory... | *Rosh Hashanah* |